

Cirqlback - Customer Guide

Customer · User Manual

For: anyone who taps a Cirql tag to earn rewards at a local business. **You need:** just your phone. **No app, no account, no sign-up required.**

1. What is Cirqlback?

Cirqlback turns a quick phone **tap** into loyalty rewards at the local shops you already visit. A business places a small **Cirql tag** (an NFC sticker or stand) on their counter. You tap it with your phone, a web page opens, and you start earning - points, punch-card progress toward a free item, discounts, and more. Everything happens in your phone's browser.

You stay **anonymous** unless you choose to share your email (used only to save your progress across visits and to send you reminders you ask for).

2. How to tap (your first reward in 10 seconds)

1. **Hold the top of your phone** near the Cirql tag (most phones read NFC near the top back).
 - *iPhone:* just hold it close - no app needed (iOS 13+).
 - *Android:* make sure **NFC is on** (Settings > Connected devices > NFC), then hold it near the tag.
 - **No NFC?** Many tags also have a **QR code** - open your camera and scan it instead.
2. A Cirqlback page opens showing the shop's current offer.
3. If it's your first time, enter your **email** (optional but recommended - it saves your progress). Then tap **Earn Reward / Tap to Earn**.
4. You'll see your reward or your updated progress right away.

Prefer another language? The tap page can translate the offer - use the language switch to read it in your language.

3. Understanding your rewards

Depending on the shop's campaign, a tap gives you one of these:

- **Points** - you accumulate points that add up toward perks and tiers.
- **A punch card** ("Tap 5 times, get a free coffee") - you'll see your dots filling in (e.g. 3 of 5). When you complete it, your reward unlocks automatically.
- **An instant reward** - a discount or freebie you can redeem now or later.

Each reward comes with a **code**. To redeem, show the reward page (or the code) to the staff. You can reopen a reward any time at `/reward?code=YOUR-CODE` - it shows whether it's **valid**, **already redeemed**, or **expired**.

Fair-play note: to keep things fair, there's a short cool-down between taps on the same tag, and some rewards ask you to be **at the shop** (your phone may ask for location permission). This just prevents abuse - a normal visit always works.

4. Finding places on the map

Open the **Discovery Map** (`/map`) to see participating businesses near you:

- **Pins** mark shops you can visit and tap.
- **Featured** shops are highlighted at the top.

- **"Support a Cause"** shows nonprofits and donation campaigns - with some shops, **every tap donates** to a local cause (you'll see a thank-you when it does).
- **Group Trails** are multi-store adventures (see below).

Tap any pin to see the shop's details, address, and a **Directions** button.

5. Multi-store trails & scavenger hunts

Some rewards span **several shops** - "Tap at 3 bakeries for a free treat" or a themed scavenger hunt. On the map, open a **Group Trail** to see the participating stores. As you tap at each one, your progress fills in (a check appears for each store). Visit the required number of stores and the group reward unlocks - **once** - automatically.

Your progress is tracked by your email and/or your device, so you don't need an account to complete a trail.

6. Favorites & reminders

- **Favorite** a shop from its tap page so you can find it again.
- Businesses you favorite may send you **reminders** (e.g. "Your punch card is almost complete!"). You control this by choosing to favorite / share your email.

Your favorites and reward feed live under **My Favorites** (accessible from the tap page once you've shared an email).

7. Frequently asked questions

Do I need to download an app? No. Everything runs in your phone's browser.

Do I need an account? No. Sharing your email is optional and only used to save progress and send reminders you opt into.

My tap didn't do anything. Make sure NFC is on (Android) and hold the phone still near the tag for a second. If there's a QR code, scan that instead. If it says "slow down," you've tapped the same tag too quickly - wait a moment.

It asked for my location. Some proximity-based rewards require you to actually be at the shop. Allow location to earn those; you can decline, but that specific reward won't unlock.

Can I use one reward twice? No - once a reward's code is redeemed it shows as "redeemed."

Is my data safe? You're anonymous by default. If you share an email, it's used only for your progress and reminders.

Happy tapping! Every tap supports a local business, and sometimes a local cause, too.
